

The very first version of Voyager is designed to leverage data centre technologies that were debuted with the top-of-the-rack switch, Wedge 100. It has a switch ASIC to aggregate the 100 GbE client signals. Additionally, there is the DSP ASIC and the optics module (AC400) from Acacia Communications to deliver an upgraded networking solution in the market.



Facebook's team has used the open line system that includes Yang software data models and an open northbound software interface to enable scalability on the new hardware infrastructure. The social networking giant has partnered with Snaprout for the software architecture of the end-to-end solution.

"An open approach allows any vendor to contribute new hardware and software to the system. In the beginning, the open line system will include Yang software data models of each component in the system, and an open northbound software interface (NETCONF and Thrift) to the control plane software," Facebook engineers Ilya Lyubomirsky, Brian Taylor and Hans-Juergen Wolfgang Schmidtke explained in a blog post.

Facebook has provided a hardware management daemon-based network element software stack with Voyager. The daemons enable configuration, management and monitoring of the hardware layer and provide services like higher-layer software to allow the provisioning of the hardware. Also, a multi-language SDK layer is available to enable third-party app development on the advanced infrastructure.

Facebook has already tested how Voyager operates in field trials with Equinix in the US and MTN in South Africa. The company is also aiming to release the code of the Voyager software to enhance its platform.

The development of an optical fibre-supported transponder like Voyager will certainly upgrade the present networking field. Besides, the open source approach will help Facebook to quickly grab attention from not just telecom operators but also several developers and data centre providers around the globe.

Ubuntu gets 'Budgie' flavour

Linux distribution Budgie-remix has transformed into a new Ubuntu flavour. With this development, the open source build is now available as 'Ubuntu Budgie'.

The team behind the platform confirms that the Ubuntu Developer Membership Board has passed Budgie as the official Ubuntu flavour after reviewing its technical aspects. For users, the transformation will bring community standards to the distribution.



"We have come a long way in a short time with our first 16.04 release — a major update at 16.04.1 as well as following and taking an active part with the Ubuntu release cadence for 16.10," the Budgie team wrote in the announcement statement.

Amazon Linux container image now available for on-premise data centres

Amazon has released the Amazon Linux container image for on-premise data centres. This new release enables Amazon Web Services (AWS) clients to deploy the same customised Linux experience on their own servers, which previously were limited to virtual machine instances by the e-commerce giant.



In addition to its on-premise presence, the Amazon Linux image can be deployed on the cloud. It is available through the EC2 Container Registry and built using the same code and packages that were initially available within the Amazon Linux AMI, which offers a 'stable, secure and high-performance' execution environment on AWS.

"Many of our customers have asked us to make this Linux image available for use on-premises, often as part of their development and testing workloads," AWS chief evangelist Jeff Barr wrote in a blog post.

The Amazon Linux image is not the only open source distribution available for AWS data centres. CentOS, CoreOS and even Red Hat Enterprise Linux and Canonical's Ubuntu are compatible with the on-premise data centres. However, the newest image is designed to use EC2 and limited remote access, with no root login and mandatory SSH key pairs to deliver a security profile. It also supports container solutions like Docker to enable advanced deployments.